Crossfuze

EDITION 2026

THE CROSSFUZE GUIDE TO AUTONOMOUS IT

The Road to Zero.

How ready are you to let AI act?



Part of Preparing for the Autonomous Enterprise

Crossfuze · ServiceNow Elite Partner

THOUGHT LEADERSHIP

Are you ready for the Autonomous Enterprise?



Nick McGillivray

PRESIDENT & CHIEF REVENUE OFFICER · CROSSFUZE

There has been a fundamental shift in the conversations I am having with customers.

A few years ago the question was what might AI make possible. Today the capabilities are here. ServiceNow is moving from AI that assists people to AI that interprets context, makes decisions and takes action.

So the question has changed. Most C-suite leaders I speak to are asking the same one:

When does IT stop reacting?

For most enterprises the answer is not yet, and the reason is rarely the technology. It's a CMDB nobody trusts, workflows nobody owns and governance that arrives too late.

Platforms get built in pieces, by different teams, under different assumptions. Context leaks away at every handover, and you end up with an estate where each part is correct, and nobody understands the whole.

We lead with that work because it's unglamorous and it's the whole job. Fix it and AI compounds. Skip it and you have an expensive assistant repeating your worst data back to you with confidence.



Having access to AI and being ready to use it are not the same thing. The distance between the two is your ServiceNow AI Readiness Gap.

AI makes execution abundant. It does not make understanding abundant. Point an agent at an estate nobody fully understands and it will carry out the wrong intent faster than any person ever could.

This is Track A of Preparing for the Autonomous Enterprise: a practical route from today's IT operation towards trusted autonomy. It starts with Autonomous IT because the data, workflows and evidence already exist there. Oliver Nowak, our AI Practice Lead, explains why on page 07.

The Road to Zero is Crossfuze's practical framework for helping organisations assess their ServiceNow AI readiness, identify the right ServiceNow Zero to pursue first and progressively earn greater permission to automate. The guide answers five questions: What is Autonomous IT? What is the ServiceNow AI Readiness Gap? Are we ready? Which Zero first? How do we get there?

Outcomes should be evidenced, not asserted. You will see the ServiceNow capabilities, the dependencies and the evidence to expect in your own estate.

The Autonomous Enterprise won't arrive as one big transformation. You will build it in deliberate, measurable steps. Each one gives you proof rather than a promise, and proof is what gives you **the confidence to keep evolving.**

Calculate your AI readiness score →

IF YOU READ ONE PAGE, READ THIS ONE

Ready to let AI act? Start here.

Five questions guide the journey. Here is the short answer to each.

01

What is Autonomous IT?

AI that identifies, decides and acts within the guardrails you set. ServiceNow's five Zeros are the destination: a direction of travel, not a date.

PAGES 04–07 →

02

What is the ServiceNow AI Readiness Gap?

The distance between what ServiceNow AI can do and what your organisation can safely let it do. You close it by making the estate safe, not by buying more capability.

PAGES 08–11 →

03

Are we ready?

Only as far as your weakest foundation allows: data, AI and agents, workflows or governance. That, plus your controls, sets your autonomy ceiling.

PAGES 12–15 · CHECKS 01–04 →

04

Which Zero should we pursue first?

The one where business value is high and the readiness gap is small. Zero-Touch Support is often the accessible start, but your estate decides.

PAGES 16–26 · CHECKS 05–07 →

05

How do we get there?

59% of enterprises have moved beyond agentic AI pilots; only **9%** have made meaningful progress on autonomous workflows. The way through is one bounded Zero at a time, proved in operation every 90 days, with your licence and Assist consumption sized before you renew.

PAGES 27–32 · CHECKS 08–10 →

THE ONE DECISION

What are you prepared to let AI do without a human in the loop, and what can you prove in the next 90 days?

Book your session →

QUESTION ONE · AUTONOMOUS IT AND THE FIVE ZEROS

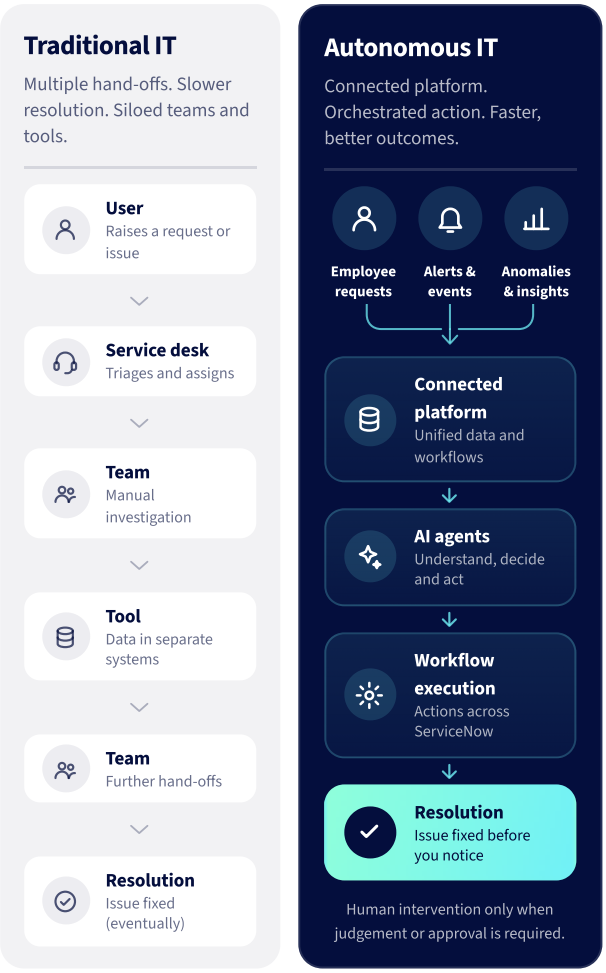
Autonomous IT is AI that can identify, decide and act within the guardrails you set.

With agentic AI, workflows can run end to end, from detection and diagnosis through to resolution, without unnecessary human intervention.

That shifts IT from reacting to tickets, outages and alerts towards preventing them, while people focus on the complex decisions, exceptions and relationships where human judgement matters most.

Humans stay in control. They set the policies, permissions and approval thresholds that determine what AI can do autonomously, what needs review and where human intervention is required.

Lee Farnsworth
Director, Growth & Market Operations, Crossfuze



SERVICENOW'S PUBLISHED POSITION

"

Zero support incidents, zero outages, zero asset issues, zero breaches, and zero misaligned investments: five outcomes on one connected platform.

Jeff Hausman
EVP & General Manager, Technology Workflows
ServiceNow

SERVICENOW WORKFLOW · 1 JULY 2026

ServiceNow's framing, not ours. Zero is a direction of travel, not a date, and one platform, one data foundation and one governance model carry all five.

Sources: ServiceNow Workflow, 1 July 2026 · AI Summit Oslo, 18 June 2026, and Zurich, 2 July 2026 · World Forum New York, 10 September 2026. Insight, Automation and Autonomy are ServiceNow's Autonomous IT ServiceOps phases, 5 May 2026, published against Zero Touch IT Support and Zero Service Outages; applying them across all five Zeros and across both tracks is Crossfuze's reading.

QUESTION ONE · THE FIVE ZEROS

Autonomous IT in five Zeros.

IT that predicts, prevents and acts, ~~not just reacts.~~

Service Desk	Tech Operations	Asset Management	CISO	Strategy & Planning
0	0	0	0	0
Touch Support	Service Outages	Asset Issues	Severe Breaches	Misaligned Investments

ALL FIVE REST ON

TRUSTED DATA · DOCUMENTED WORKFLOWS · GOVERNED AI · CLEAR OWNERSHIP

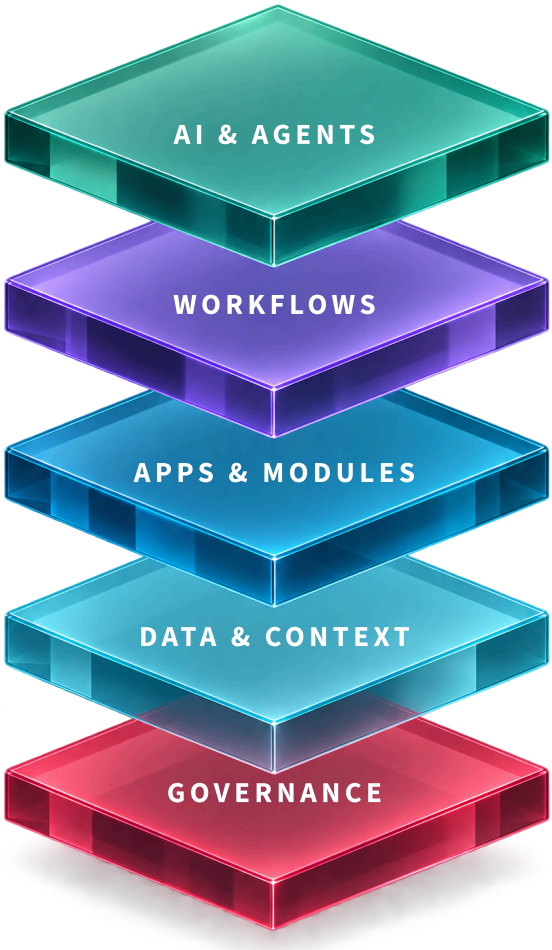
THE CATCH

ServiceNow's Five Zeros are a direction of travel, not a promise. ServiceNow capability is moving quickly. **Whether your operation has the data, workflows, controls and evidence to safely pursue them is a different question.**

QUESTION ONE · THE SERVICENOW ESTATE

A Zero is not one feature. It is a stack.

Each Zero is an operational outcome, not a product you buy. Delivering one means assembling the ServiceNow capabilities the outcome needs, **across five connected layers, grounded in trusted data and context and held within shared governance.**



05
Reasons, decides and acts
ServiceNow Otto, AI Agents, agentic workflows

04
Executes work across systems
Flows, Automation, Policies

03
Where the outcome is delivered and measured
ITSM, ITOM, ITAM (HAM and SAM), SecOps, SPM

02
What everything above depends on
CMDB, Knowledge, Foundation Data, Data Fabric

01
Authority, policy and evidence
Risk, compliance, approvals, audit, AI Control Tower

SHARED FOUNDATION

The weakest foundation sets the ceiling. A Zero is assembled from the capabilities it needs, and scoped to the smallest credible set.

Crossfuze mapping based on current ServiceNow positioning

QUESTION ONE · WHY IT FIRST

Every function wants AI to do more. IT gives us a place to prove we can trust it.



Oliver Nowak

AI PRACTICE LEAD · CROSSFUZE · SERVICENOW ELITE PARTNER

Ask a finance or HR team to show you what an agent did last quarter and you may get an anecdote.

Ask IT and you are more likely to get a record.

Ticket history. Configuration and service data. Change decisions, approvals and rollback. Resolution times, outage minutes, ownership and operational evidence.

That is not simply a technical advantage. **It is an evidential one.**

AI makes execution easier. Trust becomes the harder problem. The question is no longer what AI can execute, but whether the organisation has enough context, control and evidence to trust what happens next.

This is where Nick's question, *when does IT stop reacting?*, becomes practical. IT stops reacting when the evidence is strong enough to let the platform identify, decide and act before a person has to step in.

Permission to automate is earned.

So IT is the right place to begin: a controlled environment where greater autonomy can be introduced, observed and improved.

For an agentic workflow, we should be able to show what the system understood, what it changed, why it acted, which controls applied and what happened as a result.

Evidence makes accountability inspectable rather than rhetorical.

It also makes learning possible. A misrouted incident is visible. A failed remediation can be investigated. A change can be rolled back. What happened becomes context for the next decision.

Greater autonomy cannot mean weaker accountability. AI can take on more of the operational work, but named people still define the boundaries, own the controls and remain accountable for what runs autonomously.

You prove the data can be trusted. You prove the workflow behaves as expected. You prove the controls work. Then you expand the boundary.

Here the Five Zeros matter. They are not five isolated AI projects but measurable operational outcomes: fewer avoidable tickets, outages, asset issues and severe breaches, and less wasted investment. Each is a place to test whether greater autonomy produces a better result, and evidence for what should happen next.

The objective is not autonomy for its own sake.

It is the right level of autonomy, backed by the context, evidence and accountability required to keep evolving.

02

QUESTION TWO

What is the ServiceNow AI Readiness Gap?

ServiceNow AI capability is arriving faster than most estates can safely absorb it. **The gap is the distance between the two.** This section defines it, names what creates it, and sets out how it gets closed.

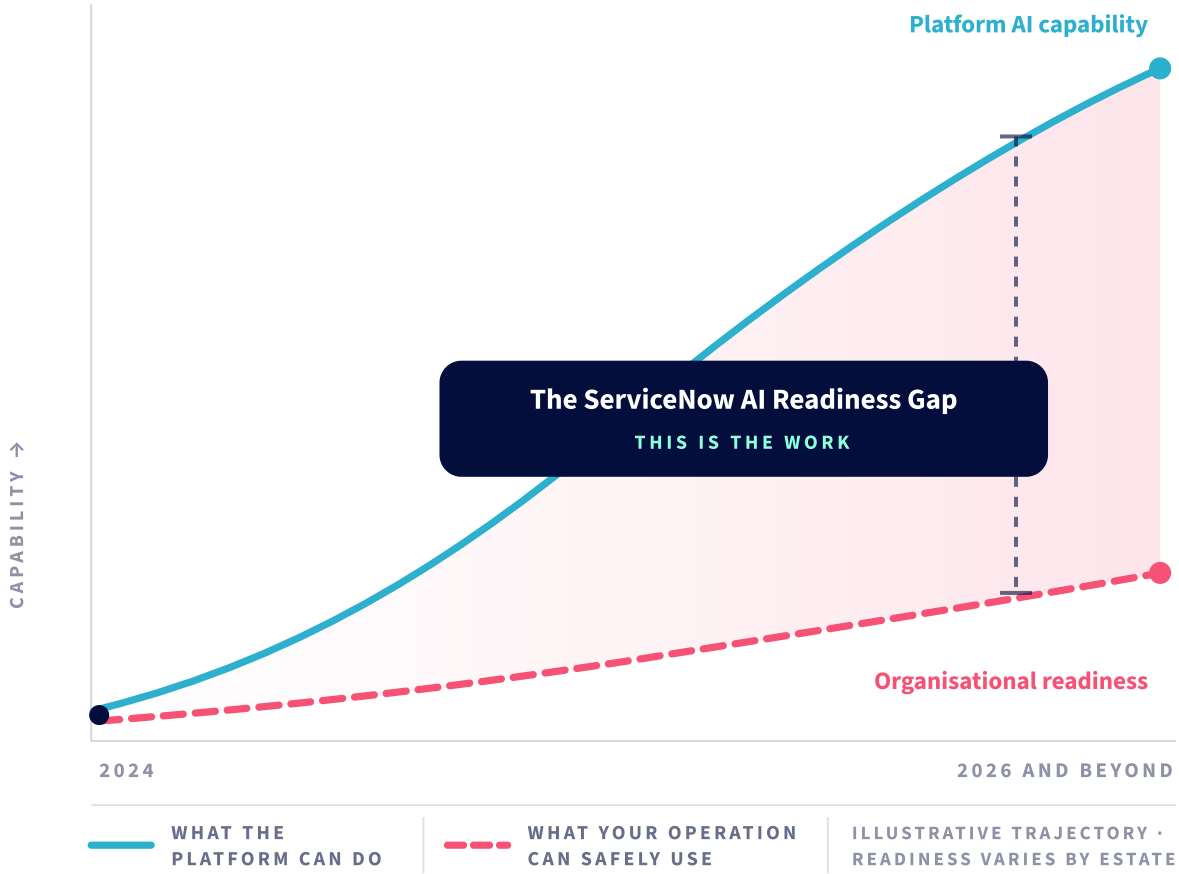
THE GAP	**What exactly is it?** The distance between what ServiceNow AI can do and what your organisation can safely let it do.
THE BARRIERS	**What gets in the way?** Silos, untrusted context, disconnected workflows, and people and ownership.
THE ROAD	**How does it get closed?** Not in one transformation. One bounded Zero at a time, proved in operation.

QUESTION TWO · THE GAP

The ServiceNow AI Readiness Gap is the distance between what ServiceNow AI can do and what your organisation can safely let it do.

Data, AI & Agents, workflows and governance determine that distance.

EXHIBIT 01 · THE EXECUTION GAP



The gap is not closed by buying more capability. It is closed by making the estate safe to hand it to.

Crossfuze assesses readiness across the foundations of data, AI & Agents, workflows and governance to identify what must change before autonomy can safely increase.

Calculate your readiness →

QUESTION TWO · THE BARRIERS

What gets in the way of Autonomous IT?

ServiceNow's own experience, and what we hear from CIOs, points to the same barriers repeatedly. **The technology can be ready before the organisation is ready to trust it.**

01

Silos

Data, teams and technology operate separately.

AI attached to individual solutions recreates the silos it was meant to remove.

THE IMPLICATION

Connect data, AI and workflows through a common platform.

02

Untrusted context

AI cannot reason reliably from data it cannot trust.

Poor CMDB health, fragmented data and inconsistent knowledge reduce confidence in autonomous action.

THE IMPLICATION

Limits the autonomy ceiling and increases risk.

03

Disconnected workflows

Automating an old process is not the same as redesigning the work.

Agents solve isolated tasks. Autonomous IT requires end-to-end workflows that allow AI to interpret context, make decisions and act.

THE IMPLICATION

Don't automate what you already do. Reimagine the work.

04

People and ownership

Autonomy requires organisational permission, not just technical capability.

Teams need the skills, ownership, controls and confidence to allow AI greater authority, with clear accountability and human judgement where it is still needed.

THE IMPLICATION

Education, upskilling and clear governance unlock autonomy.

NEXT Each barrier widens your ServiceNow AI Readiness Gap. Page 11 sets out how to close it, one bounded Zero at a time.

FROM THE READINESS GAP

QUESTION TWO · THE ROAD

Close the gap. Start the Road to Zero.

You do not close the gap in one transformation. You close enough of it to act safely, choose a bounded Zero outcome, carry the intent and operating context into controlled change, then prove what changed in operation.



01 Measure readiness

Know where you can safely start.

Assess the estate, the foundations and the current boundary for autonomous action.

02 Chosen Zero

Outcome selected.

Choose the Zero where business value, operational need and readiness intersect.

03 Intent + context

Understand + align.

Define the goal, workflow, AI role, measure and authority before anything is allowed to act.

04 Decisions + controlled change

Change.

Configure, integrate, test and prepare the organisation with the right governance and risk management.

05 Evidence + operation

Prove + evolve.

Track adoption, value and risk in operation. Prove the outcome and capture what the relationship learns.

06 Next Zero

Informed by what changed.

Use the evidence to increase permission, extend the workflow or prioritise the next Zero.

TOWARDS AN AUTONOMOUS ENTERPRISE

CONTINUOUS CONTEXT
What the relationship learns travels forward.

HUMAN ACCOUNTABILITY
Named people remain responsible.

Permission to automate expands as evidence grows.

The next Zero starts higher.

QUESTION THREE

Are we ready for Autonomous IT?

Page 09 names the gap. This section measures yours. **Readiness is not a feeling.** It is evidence about the condition of your estate, the controls around it and what autonomous action can safely be trusted to do.

03

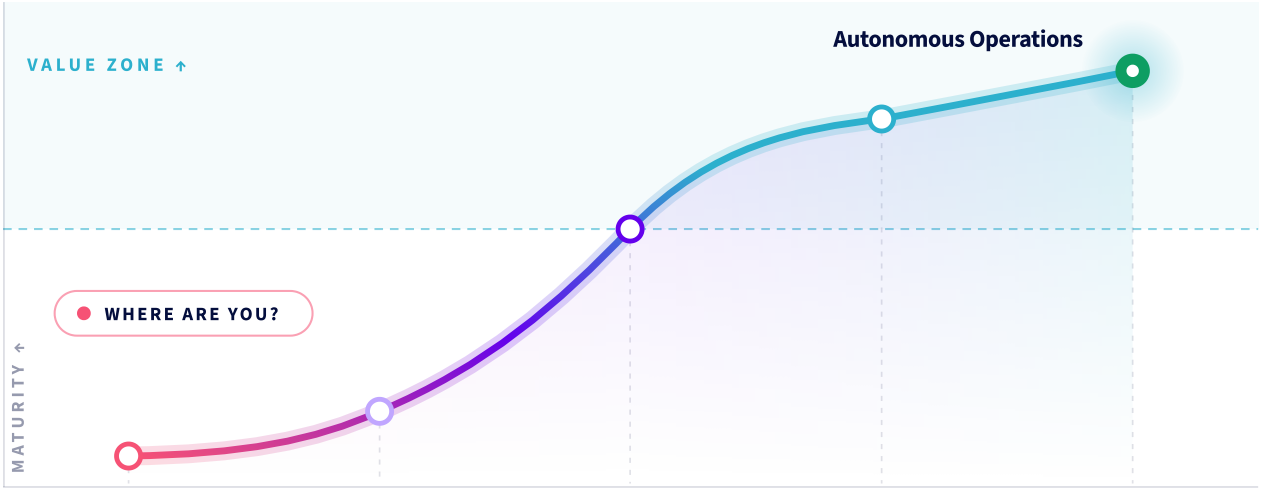
THE ESTATE	**What condition is the platform in?** CMDB/CSDM, Discovery, service mapping, knowledge, workflow reach and asset data.
THE CEILING	**How far can autonomy safely extend?** Your weakest foundation sets the practical limit.
YOUR POSITION	**Where does that put us today?** A stage, an overall readiness score and a score for each foundation.
THE PERMISSION	**What can act, under what controls, and who is accountable?** Authority, controls, named ownership, evidence and recovery have to be explicit.

QUESTION THREE · THE ESTATE

How ready are you?

ServiceNow's crawl, walk, run progression gives the direction. **Your evidence determines where your estate actually sits on the five-stage path to greater autonomy.** Autonomy becomes practical at stage 03.

THE READINESS JOURNEY — AUTONOMY BECOMES PRACTICAL AT STAGE 03



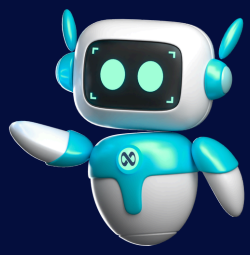
01	02	03	04	05
Ad Hoc FOUNDATION	**Manual** CRAWL	**Un-Siloed** WALK	**End-to-End** RUN	**Autonomous** FLY
Manually maintained CMDB. Discovery absent or partial. Knowledge written once and never retired.	Discovery running but unmapped. ITSM standardised in places. Automation exists as scripts, not flows.	CSDM-aligned CMDB, service mapping for critical services, Flow Designer coverage, integrations in place.	ITOM correlating events to services. HAM and SAM reconciled. Agentic workflows in production inside limits.	Continuous discovery and remediation. Portfolio decisions fed by live operational data.

Crossfuze readiness scale, with ServiceNow's crawl, walk, run pacing. The Five Zero outcomes and the Autonomous IT ambition are ServiceNow's. The readiness scale is Crossfuze's.

READY TO PLACE YOURSELF? **Take the AI Readiness Benchmark →**

QUESTION THREE · THE CEILING

What sets your autonomy ceiling?



Four foundations determine how far AI can safely act in your ServiceNow estate.

01

Data

Can AI trust the context?

- CMDB health & CSDM alignment
- Knowledge freshness & ownership

02

AI & Agents

Can it make a grounded decision?

- Grounding in approved knowledge & policy
- Decision evaluation & escalation thresholds

03

Workflows

Can it carry out the action?

- Integration reach across required systems
- Standard paths & defined exceptions

04

Governance

Is the action permitted, controlled and reviewable?

- Named decision & override owners
- Tested stop & recovery controls

Your weakest foundation sets your autonomy ceiling.

Named people remain accountable.

QUESTION THREE · THE PERMISSION

What must be true before AI acts?

Seven controls define the boundary for autonomous action: **what can act, what it can touch, who owns it, how it is evidenced and how it can be stopped or reversed.** Only 20% of enterprises have implemented AI testing, auditing and risk assessment.

Source: ServiceNow Enterprise AI Maturity Index 2026

01	**Inventory** What is actually running?	Every agent, model and integration should be discoverable and owned. **You cannot govern what you have not found.**
02	**Risk tier** How much does it matter?	Apply controls proportionate to the potential operational, regulatory and customer impact. **Not every use case needs the same level of control.**
03	**Authority** What may it touch, change or approve?	Define what the agent can access, change, approve and spend, and where a person must decide. **Autonomy needs explicit boundaries.**
04	**Explainability** Can we show why it acted?	Record what the system saw, what it did and the evidence behind the action. **If you cannot explain an action, you cannot properly assure it.**
05	**Exception handling** When does a human take over?	Define when work returns to a person, who owns it and how quickly they must respond. **Autonomy needs a designed handover path.**
06	**Kill switch** How do we stop it?	Provide a controlled way to stop an agent or process immediately. **Stop what is happening.**
07	**Rollback** How do we undo it?	Define how an action is reversed and who owns recovery. **Undo what has happened.**

WHERE THE CONTROLS LIVE

ServiceNow AI Control Tower can provide the inventory, governance and operational oversight layer. Crossfuze then maps the control model to customer policy and recognised frameworks such as **NIST AI RMF** and **ISO/IEC 42001**.

One accountable owner. Named service, operations, security and platform stakeholders.

THE Q3 ANSWER

You are ready only to the level your weakest foundation and control boundary allow.

Readiness is the intersection of estate condition, autonomy ceiling and permission to act.

QUESTION FOUR

Which Zero should we pursue first?

Five Zeros. Five different outcomes. The first one should not simply be the biggest prize on paper. Start where business value, ServiceNow readiness and estate fit point to the strongest next move.

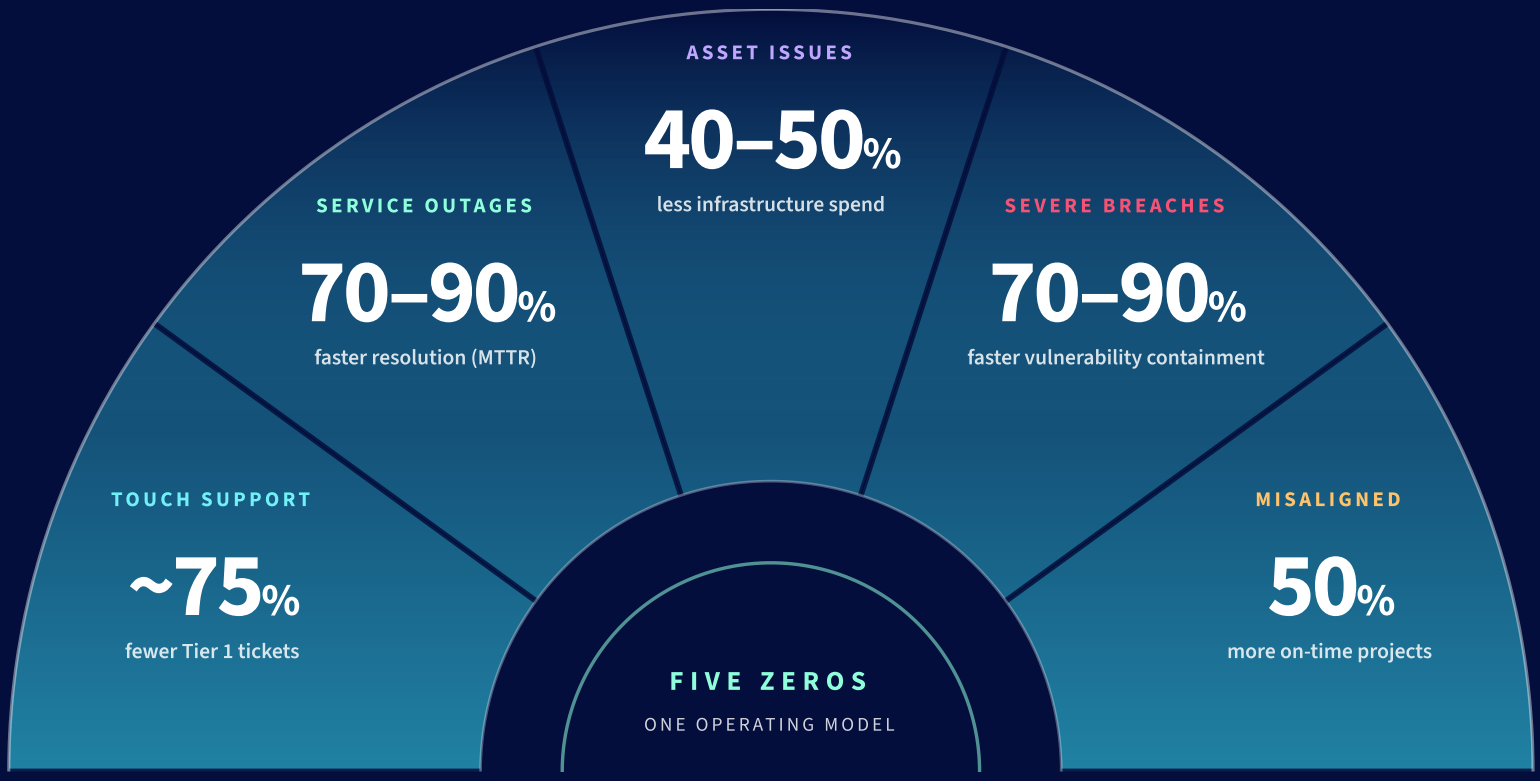
04

THE STAKES	**What is each Zero worth?** Each Zero carries a measurable operational outcome. Size the prize before choosing where to start.
THE DECISION	**Where should we start?** Start where business value is high and the readiness gap standing in front of the outcome is manageable.
THE DEPENDENCY	**Why does sequence matter?** The Five Zeros share ServiceNow foundations. Work done for one can strengthen what becomes practical next.
THE FIT	**How does our estate change the answer?** The same Zero can be an obvious first move for one customer and the wrong starting point for another.

QUESTION FOUR · THE STAKES

What each Zero could unlock.

Each Zero carries a measurable operational outcome. **Which to pursue first is the question that follows.**



AUTONOMOUS IT · FIVE OUTCOMES · SHARED FOUNDATIONS

WHAT THE NUMBERS MEAN

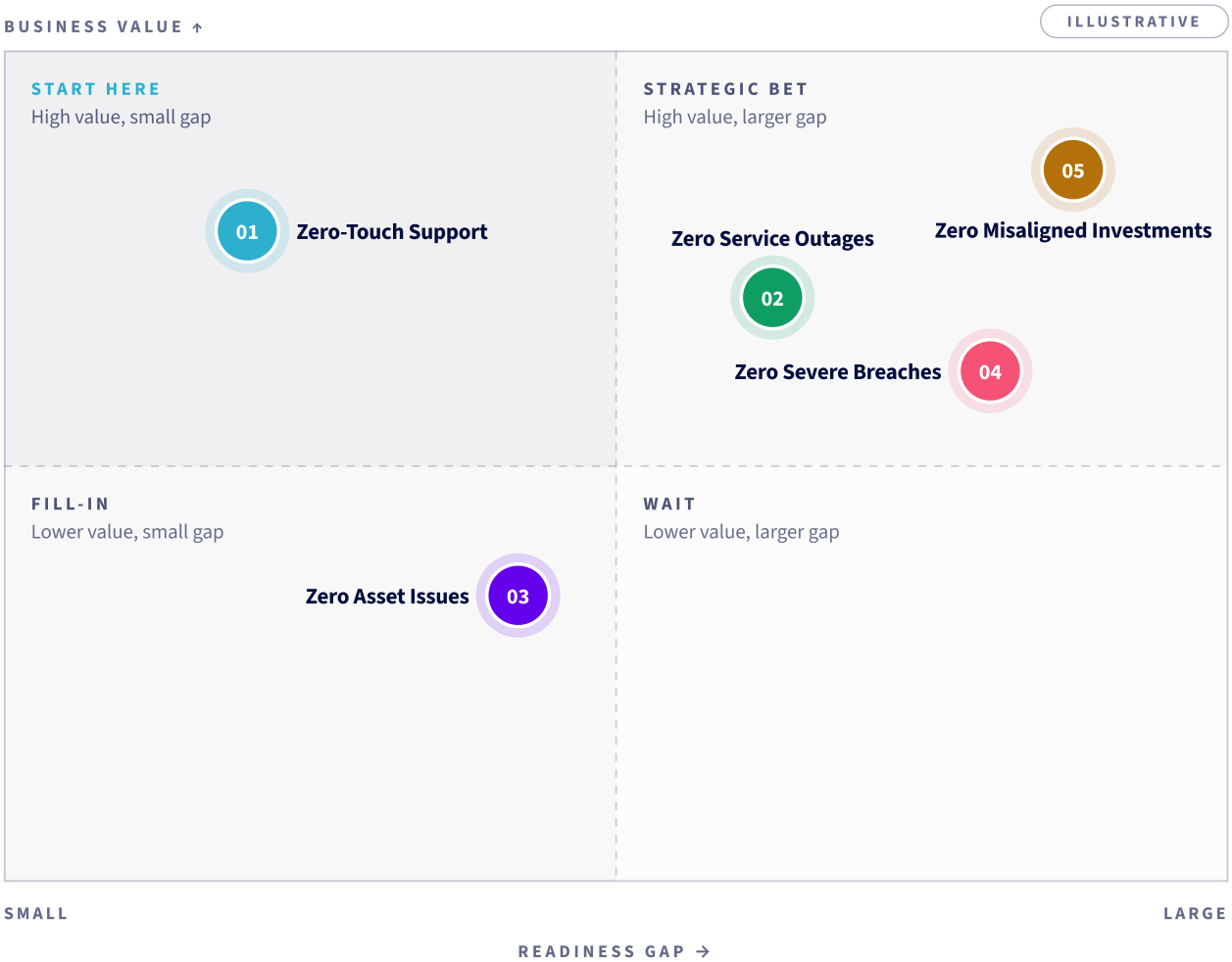
These are ServiceNow business-value estimates, not five independently audited customer outcomes. Source: ServiceNow, 'Autonomous IT: Where zeros make heroes' · 2026 (vendor-published). 'Numbers listed are estimates based on known customer outcomes and business value assessment projections. Your results may vary.' (ServiceNow)

QUESTION FOUR · THE DECISION

Which Zero should we tackle first?

There is no universal first Zero. Plot each outcome against the value it could create and the readiness gap standing in front of it. **Start where value is high and the readiness gap is smallest. Everything else is sequencing, not rejection.**

THE FIVE ZEROS, PLOTTED



Positions illustrative until scored. Use your readiness evidence for the horizontal axis and your business case for the vertical axis.

01	**Zero-Touch Support** · often an accessible starting point	22
02	**Zero Service Outages** · high operational value, deeper engineering dependency	23
03	**Zero Asset Issues** · can strengthen shared foundations	24
04	**Zero Severe Breaches** · control and governance matter as much as capability	25
05	**Zero Misaligned Investments** · potentially high strategic value, dependent on connected evidence	26

QUESTION FOUR · THE DEPENDENCY

What does the first Zero make easier next?

The Five Zeros share ServiceNow foundations.

Work completed for one can reduce the readiness work required for another. The first Zero is not only an outcome. **It also changes the starting position for what comes next.**

SHARED WORK THAT CAN BE REUSED

Foundation	01 Zero-Touch Support	02 Zero Service Outages	03 Zero Asset Issues	04 Zero Severe Breaches	05 Zero Misaligned Investments
Governance and action boundaries Named accountability and a reusable control model, carried forward and revalidated for each Zero.	●	●	●	●	●
CMDB, CSDM and Discovery Trusted service context: what exists, what it depends on, what it affects.	●	●	●	●	○
Knowledge and workflow standardisation Standard paths that make automated resolution and lifecycle actions safe to run.	●	●	●	○	○
Asset and service data accuracy HAM and SAM accuracy feeding prioritisation and portfolio decisions.	○	○	●	●	●

WHAT THIS LOOKS LIKE IN PRACTICE

02 → 03

Zero Service Outages → Zero Asset Issues

Build once	Discovery · CMDB/CSDM · dependency accuracy
Reuse next	Asset normalisation · reconciliation · lifecycle control

01 → 04

Zero-Touch Support → Zero Severe Breaches

Build once	Workflow standardisation · automation controls
Reuse next	Security response workflows · action boundaries

THE RULE

Sequence the Zeros. Do not run them as five projects.

Choose the first Zero for the value it creates now, then use the shared foundations it builds to improve the starting position for what comes next.

Which starting point fits your estate?

The same ambition can require a different first move.

Your current ServiceNow estate determines what is credible now. **These five common estate starting points show how existing capability changes the best starting Zero**, and the enabling work needed to go further.

01

ITSM-led estate

Incident, request and change are on-platform. Knowledge is uneven, with limited automation and little operational context.



FIRST ZERO p.22

01 Zero-Touch Support

Automate the everyday.

ENABLING WORK

- Self-service and knowledge
- Data quality and standardisation
- Workflow hygiene and integrations

UNLOCKS NEXT

- 02 Zero Service Outages
- 03 Zero Asset Issues

02

ITSM + emerging ITOM

Core service workflows are established. Discovery and event visibility exist in part, but service context and automation are incomplete.



FIRST ZERO p.23

02 Zero Service Outages

Predict and prevent disruption.

ENABLING WORK

- CSDM alignment and service mapping
- Event correlation and noise reduction
- HAM and SAM into the CMDB

UNLOCKS NEXT

- 03 Zero Asset Issues
- 04 Zero Severe Breaches

03

Asset-led clean-up

Asset data is broad but inconsistent. Discovery, HAM or SAM are present, but reconciliation, ownership and trust remain weak.



FIRST ZERO p.24

03 Zero Asset Issues

Trust what you have.

ENABLING WORK

- Data normalisation and reconciliation
- Clear ownership and governance
- Rationalise tools and processes

UNLOCKS NEXT

- 02 Zero Service Outages
- 05 Zero Misaligned Investments

04

Security-led estate

Security operations are active, but asset and service context are incomplete. Detection exists, yet response is more reactive than connected.



FIRST ZERO p.25

04 Zero Severe Breaches

Stop threats earlier.

ENABLING WORK

- Asset and vulnerability visibility
- Service context for security
- Detection, response and automation

UNLOCKS NEXT

- 02 Zero Service Outages
- 03 Zero Asset Issues

05

Portfolio-led change

Multiple initiatives sit on the platform. Demand, portfolio and resource data exist, but alignment and benefits evidence are weak.



FIRST ZERO p.26

05 Zero Misaligned Investments

Invest in what matters.

ENABLING WORK

- Clear demand and intake
- Portfolio and resource transparency
- Benefits tracking and value realisation

UNLOCKS NEXT

- 02 Zero Service Outages
- 03 Zero Asset Issues

READING THE STACK — Established capability · Emerging or partial · Not yet in place

QUESTION FOUR · THE CAPABILITIES

The capabilities behind the Zeros.

Each Zero is delivered through a different combination of ServiceNow capabilities, but the same rule applies: **the outcome can only be as strong as the weakest foundation beneath it.**

CAPABILITY	WHAT IT CONTRIBUTES	ZERO-TOUCH SUPPORT	ZERO SERVICE OUTAGES	ZERO ASSET ISSUES	ZERO SEVERE BREACHES	ZERO MISALIGNED INVESTMENTS
LAYER 01 · GOVERNANCE						
AI Control Tower	AI discovery, governance, security, observability and control	○	○	○	○	○
LAYER 02 · DATA & CONTEXT						
CMDB & CSDM	Trusted service and configuration context for AI, workflows and decisions	○	○	○	○	–
Discovery	Continuously discovered infrastructure and CI visibility	–	○	○	○	–
LAYER 03 · APPS & MODULES						
ITSM	Incident, request, problem, change and service-desk workflows	●	○	–	–	–
ITOM	Events, service mapping, AIOps and automated remediation	○	●	–	–	–
HAM	Hardware lifecycle, inventory, cost and risk control	–	–	●	–	–
SAM	Software lifecycle, entitlement, compliance, spend and risk	○	–	●	○	○
SecOps	Vulnerability and security incident response with service context	–	–	–	●	–
SPM	Aligns investments, demand and delivery to strategy	–	–	–	–	●
LAYER 04 · WORKFLOWS						
Flow Designer & IntegrationHub	Workflow automation and cross-system execution rails	○	○	○	○	○
LAYER 05 · AI & AGENTS						
ServiceNow Otto & AI Agents	Reasoning, triage, summarisation and governed autonomous action	●	○	○	○	○

● Primary capability ○ Supporting capability – No material role asserted in this mapping

Crossfuze mapping based on current ServiceNow positioning.

QUESTION FOUR · THE ZERO

ZERO 01 OF 05
WHAT IS ZERO-TOUCH SUPPORT?

Zero-Touch Support.

Resolve the need before a ticket is raised.

~75% (1)

reduction in Tier 1 tickets

ServiceNow estimate

OWNED BY
HEAD OF SERVICE DESK

TODAY

Routine issues still become tickets that wait for a person.

→

WITH AUTONOMOUS IT

Signals are understood, resolved and learned from without an interaction.

01

What prevents it

Poor knowledge. Fragmented workflows. Missing context at the point of decision. Systems that do not talk to each other.

02

What must be true

Trusted knowledge. Standardised workflows. Integrated systems. Permissions defined before anything acts. Guardrails that hold under volume.

03

Your first move

Find the high-volume, low-risk demand. Separate what needs a human from what exists only because the process says so.

WHAT ENABLES THIS ZERO

SERVICENOW CAPABILITIES

ITSM · Now Assist · Virtual Agent · Knowledge · Flow Designer · **ITOM** for proactive prevention

PLATFORM DEPENDENCIES

Current knowledge · standard request and incident workflows · CMDB context · event and monitoring feeds

HOW CROSSFUZE HELPS

01 Assess →
Know where you stand.
Output: **Readiness baseline**

02 Design →
Sequence the use cases.
Output: **Approved use-case roadmap**

03 Execute
Deploy and run.
Output: **Live, governed outcome**

WHAT IT CONSUMES

Readiness cost

Often led by knowledge quality and process standardisation. **A practical lower-cost starting point** where support processes are already mature.

Assist consumption

Often **high-volume, smaller actions**. A 0–4-tool agentic run consumes **25 assists**; a 9–20-tool run consumes 150. Model the run mix and volume.

Zero-touch is not a faster service desk. It removes the interaction.

QUESTION FOUR · THE ZERO

ZERO 02 OF 05

WHAT IS ZERO SERVICE OUTAGES?

Zero Service Outages.

Prevent disruption before it becomes an outage.

70–90% (2)

reduction in mean time to resolution

ServiceNow estimate

OWNED BY
HEAD OF TECH OPERATIONS

TODAY

Too many alerts escalate into outages and reactive war rooms.

WITH AUTONOMOUS IT

Signals are correlated, predicted and remediated before service is lost.

01 What prevents it

Unreliable telemetry. Service context nobody trusts. Dependency maps out of date the week after they are built. Remediation that cannot be repeated.

02 What must be true

Trusted service context. Accurate dependencies. Repeatable remediation. Escalation thresholds agreed in advance, not argued during the incident.

03 Your first move

Baseline MTTR, MTTA and MTTD before improving any of them. You cannot prove prevention without knowing what today costs.

WHAT ENABLES THIS ZERO

SERVICENOW CAPABILITIES

ITOM · Discovery · Service Mapping · Event Management · AIOps · Orchestration

PLATFORM DEPENDENCIES

Reliable telemetry · CMDB and CSDM alignment · current dependency maps · repeatable remediation

HOW CROSSFUZE HELPS

01 Assess →
Know where you stand.
Output: **Readiness baseline**

02 Design →
Sequence the use cases.
Output: **Approved use-case roadmap**

03 Execute
Deploy and run.
Output: **Live, governed outcome**

WHAT IT CONSUMES

Readiness cost

Telemetry and dependency accuracy can make this **an engineering-intensive starting point**. The same work raises the ceiling on Zero Asset Issues, so plan them together.

Assist consumption

Fewer events, but correlate-and-remediate is a **wide agentic run**: nine to twenty tools at **150 assists**, against 25 for a narrow one.

MTTR matters less when the incident never happens.

QUESTION FOUR · THE ZERO

ZERO 03 OF 05

WHAT IS ZERO ASSET ISSUES?

Zero Asset Issues.

Know every asset: current, connected and trusted.

40–50% (3)

decrease in hardware, software and cloud spend

ServiceNow estimate

OWNED BY
HEAD OF ASSET MANAGEMENT

TODAY

Every asset class is tracked separately, and the record drifts from reality.

WITH AUTONOMOUS IT

One continuously understood estate, discovered rather than declared.

01

What prevents it

A different system and process for every asset class. Lifecycle data that ages faster than anyone can update it, so record and reality drift apart.

02

What must be true

Normalised models. Continuous discovery. Assets mapped to the services they support. End of life visible early enough to plan, not react.

03

Your first move

Start where assets already cause incidents. It is the fastest route to this Zero, and overlaps almost entirely with Zero Service Outages.

WHAT ENABLES THIS ZERO

SERVICENOW CAPABILITIES

HAM Pro · **SAM Pro** · Discovery · Service Graph Connectors · CMDB · normalisation

PLATFORM DEPENDENCIES

Normalised models · continuous discovery · assets mapped to services · contract and lifecycle data in one place

HOW CROSSFUZE HELPS

01 Assess →
Know where you stand.
Output: **Readiness baseline**

02 Design →
Sequence the use cases.
Output: **Approved use-case roadmap**

03 Execute
Deploy and run.
Output: **Live, governed outcome**

WHAT IT CONSUMES

Readiness cost

Discovery and normalisation across asset classes require **initial investment and ongoing upkeep**. Shared data work can also support the outages outcome.

Assist consumption

Scheduled reconciliation can mean **lower ongoing consumption**. A 0–4-tool agentic run consumes **25 assists**; total demand depends on scope and frequency.

You cannot autonomously manage what you cannot reliably see.

QUESTION FOUR · THE ZERO

ZERO 04 OF 05

WHAT IS ZERO SEVERE BREACHES?

Zero Severe Breaches.

Contain risk before it becomes a breach.

70–90% (4)

improvement in time to contain a vulnerability

ServiceNow estimate

OWNED BY
CHIEF INFORMATION SECURITY OFFICER

TODAY

Every detection joins a queue, and the queue decides what gets investigated.

→

WITH AUTONOMOUS IT

Detections are contextualised and prioritised, so containment starts at the top.

01

What prevents it

Alert volume without context. Exposure data disconnected from the estate it describes. No agreed limits on what autonomous action may do.

02

What must be true

Threat context tied to services and assets. Explicit action boundaries. An audit trail that holds at volume. Rollback is not optional.

03

Your first move

Write down what AI may do without approval before enabling it, then enforce it in **AI Control Tower** so document and platform agree.

WHAT ENABLES THIS ZERO

SERVICENOW CAPABILITIES

SecOps · Vulnerability Response · Security Incident Response · Configuration Compliance

PLATFORM DEPENDENCIES

Exposure data tied to the estate · service ownership · action boundaries in writing · an audit trail at volume

HOW CROSSFUZE HELPS

01 Assess →
Know where you stand.
Output: **Readiness baseline**

02 Design →
Sequence the use cases.
Output: **Approved use-case roadmap**

03 Execute
Deploy and run.
Output: **Live, governed outcome**

WHAT IT CONSUMES

Readiness cost

Governance design is a substantial part of the work, alongside response engineering. Agree boundaries across security, risk and IT before expanding autonomy.

Assist consumption

Typically **50 assists** per enrichment run. The real variable is **how much runs without approval**, so consumption is a policy decision.

Decide in writing where human authority stays absolute.

ZERO 05 OF 05
WHAT IS ZERO MISALIGNED INVESTMENTS?

Zero Misaligned Investments.

Align strategy, investment and delivery.

50% (5)

increase in projects completed on time

ServiceNow estimate

OWNED BY
HEAD OF STRATEGY AND PLANNING

TODAY

Strategy says one thing; portfolio, projects and operations fund another.

→

WITH AUTONOMOUS IT

Strategy, investment, delivery and services move as one line of sight.

01

What prevents it

Planning cycles slower than the work they are meant to direct. Application impact nobody can model. Objectives that live in one system and delivery that lives in another.

02

What must be true

Portfolio decisions tied to live service and asset reality. Roadmaps that move when the evidence moves, not when the annual cycle allows.

03

Your first move

Pick the one investment decision you could not currently defend with data, and work backwards from it until you can.

WHAT ENABLES THIS ZERO

SERVICENOW CAPABILITIES

SPM · Strategic Planning · Demand · APM · live ITSM, ITOM and HAM/SAM data

PLATFORM DEPENDENCIES

Portfolio tied to real service and asset data · application ownership · evidence-led cadence

HOW CROSSFUZE HELPS

01 Assess →
Know where you stand.
Output: **Readiness baseline**

02 Design →
Sequence the use cases.
Output: **Approved use-case roadmap**

03 Execute
Deploy and run.
Output: **Live, governed outcome**

WHAT IT CONSUMES

Readiness cost

Joining portfolio, delivery and service data and changing the planning cadence. **Potentially a substantial organisational investment**, with technical effort depending on data quality and integration.

Assist consumption

Often **lower-volume, broader actions**. A 9–20-tool agentic run consumes **150 assists**; budget for the actual tool mix and planning-cycle demand.

Autonomy without direction is faster execution of the wrong priorities.

05

QUESTION FIVE

How do we get there?

Choosing the Zero defines the outcome ambition. Getting there means changing the estate without losing the intent, context and controls that made it worth pursuing.

THE ROUTE

What does the journey look like?
From chosen Zero to trusted outcome, with intent, context and controls carried through into operation.

THE KEY

How is readiness scored?
The in-depth AI Readiness Assessment scores seven weighted dimensions before any Zero is designed.

THE METHOD

How does Crossfuze get you there?
Assess, Design, Execute: a readiness baseline, an approved use-case roadmap, then a live, governed outcome.

THE LICENCE

Can we afford to run it?
Size the ServiceNow tier and Assist consumption to the roadmap, not just today's usage.

THE OUTCOME

Is it delivering?
Measure what changed after go-live, and use the evidence to decide what happens next.

THE FIRST STEP ON THE ROAD TO ZERO

Know where you stand.

A free 90-minute AI Readiness Assessment gives you the readiness baseline every Zero is built on.

QUESTION FIVE · THE ROUTE

From chosen Zero to trusted outcome.

The maturity curve shows where you are. The Road to Zero identifies where to move. The Crossfuze method governs how it is delivered and proved. **We carry the intent and operating context into controlled change,** then follow it into operation to prove what changed and what comes next.

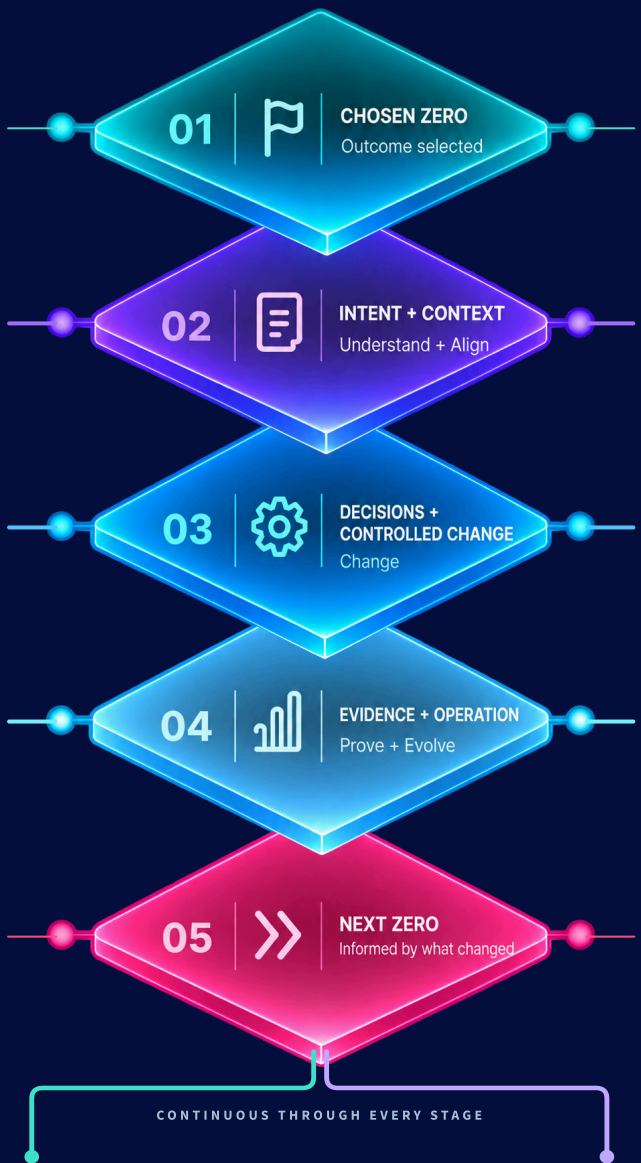
A STRONGER ESTATE, ONE ZERO AT A TIME.

INSIGHTS TRAVEL FORWARD.

PEOPLE, PROCESS AND DATA MOVE TOGETHER.

REAL OUTCOMES CREATE WHAT'S NEXT.

THE NEXT ZERO STARTS HIGHER.



A clear operational outcome with defined scope and value.

Focused, achievable and aligned to business priorities.

Understand the intent, users, processes, data and constraints.

Align stakeholders and define what success looks like.

Configure, integrate, test and prepare the organisation for change with the right governance and risk management.

Track adoption, value and risk in operation.

Validate outcomes and identify what to improve.

Use what we have learned to prioritise and define the next Zero.

CONTINUOUS THROUGH EVERY STAGE

CONTINUOUS CONTEXT
What the relationship learns travels forward.

HUMAN ACCOUNTABILITY
Named people remain responsible.

QUESTION FIVE · THE KEY

Every Zero starts with a readiness score.

The Crossfuze AI Readiness Assessment scores readiness separately from opportunity, so a valuable idea in an unready organisation is never mistaken for a safe one. The online version scores the four foundations shown on page 14. The 90-minute in-depth session breaks the same foundations into seven weighted dimensions.

WHAT IT SCORES

Seven weighted dimensions.

01	**Data quality** DATA Reliable fields, records and classifications		20%
02	**Process determinism** WORKFLOWS Decisions, exceptions and rollback understood		15%
03	**Knowledge and content** AI & AGENTS Approved, current content to ground answers		15%
04	**Workflow and integration** WORKFLOWS The technical estate can run the work end to end		15%
05	**Governance and security** GOVERNANCE Access, approval, monitoring and stop controls		15%
06	**Platform and entitlement** ZERO-SPECIFIC · ESTIMATOR, P31 Versions, licensing and surfaces fit the plan		10%
07	**Ownership and adoption** GOVERNANCE Named owners, real users, capacity to measure		10%

HOW A SCORE IS BUILT

Scores you can defend

Five anchors, nothing in between. Every score has to be argued.

0	3	5	8	10
None	Weak	Mixed	Strong	Direct

Findings with a status

Every finding carries one of six states, and its wording matches the state.

Observed · **Calculated** · **Inferred** · **Assumed** · **Validated** · **Corrected**

Gaps stay visible

Missing evidence is never scored as zero.

Full	100% of the weight evidenced
Provisional	At least 80%, including every 20% dimension
Unavailable	Otherwise

The score decides what happens next.

Not ready	Fix the foundation first, then reassess.
Ready	Design the use-case roadmap for the chosen Zero.

QUESTION FIVE · THE METHOD

From chosen Zero to production.

Three stages take you from readiness to a live outcome. Assess where you stand, design the roadmap, then execute through Crossfuze AI Run State (CARS).

AI READINESS ASSESSMENT
90-min session

01 Assess

Know where you stand.

Score readiness across data, workflows, AI & Agents and governance, and get a clear picture of what your data says.

OUTPUT

Readiness baseline

CROSSFUZE AI RUN STATE (CARS)
One engagement, two phases

02 Design

Sequence the use cases.

Decide which use cases to deploy in the short, medium and long term. Set the autonomy boundary, controls and human approvals.

OUTPUT

Approved use-case roadmap

03 Execute

Deploy and run.

Build, test and go live, then hand over into run-state ownership. Work runs in 90-day cycles, each proving one bounded outcome before the next begins.

OUTPUT

Live, governed outcome

What did the assessment find?

The AI Readiness Assessment shows whether trusted data, fit-for-purpose processes and the right governance are in place.

NOT READY

Fix the foundation first.

Address core dependencies so the outcome can be delivered and sustained.

- Data
- AI & Agents
- Workflows
- Governance

→ Reassess, then continue to Design.

READY

Move to Design.

Sequence the use cases, then execute through CARS.

02 Design

OUTPUT

Approved use-case roadmap

→

03 Execute

OUTPUT

Live, governed outcome

→ Hand over into run-state ownership.

QUESTION FIVE · THE LICENCE

Three packages. AI in every tier.

No separate purchase. No add-on SKUs. Existing SKUs reached end of sale on 1 July 2026, so the tier you renew on has to fit the Zero you are heading for.

SERVICENOW · 9 APRIL 2026

Foundation

AI to assist with work

OOTB GenAI Skills & AI Agents

- Summarisation
- Pattern recognition
- Categorisation
- Task-based assistance

TYPICAL TODAY

Standard / Pro

Advanced

AI to accelerate workflows

OOTB Agentic Workflows

- Understands context
- Applies domain knowledge
- Automates an entire process

TYPICAL TODAY

Pro Plus / Enterprise

Prime

AI to deliver autonomous outcomes

Build Custom AI Specialists, Agents & Skills

- Fully independent
- Makes decisions
- Role-based expertise

TYPICAL TODAY

Enterprise Plus

ASSISTED → AGENTIC → AUTONOMOUS

ACROSS ALL TIERS: Moveworks · Workflow Data Fabric · AI Control Tower · Process Mining*

Four questions to answer before you renew.

BEFORE SIGNING

01 CAPABILITY

Does the tier support the AI the chosen Zero needs?

ITOM and CSM have no Foundation tier. Advanced is now the minimum.

02 CONSUMPTION Estimator

What will the planned workflows consume at scale?

At equal run volumes, a 150-assist agentic run consumes 6× as many assists as a 25-assist run.

03 ENTITLEMENT Estimator

Does the included Assist allocation cover that demand?

Assists and Data Fabric credits are separate meters. Model both.

04 RENEWAL

Are tier, entitlement and overage agreed before you sign?

Remove bundled legacy line items and lock top-up pricing in writing.

WE BUILT A TOOL FOR THIS

Crossfuze ServiceNow Assist Estimator

Project a 12-month Now Assist consumption forecast across ServiceNow products and check it against your licence tier and allocation. Answers questions 02 and 03 in minutes.

Open the Estimator →

crossfuze.com/interactive-tools

* Process Mining included in Advanced and Prime only. Source: ServiceNow New Commercial Model Overview, April 2026.

QUESTION FIVE · THE OUTCOME

Go-live is a threshold. Not the finish line.

Go-live delivers capability. Operation proves the outcome. Measure what actually changed, use the evidence to decide what happens next, and keep learning in operation.

SUCCESS LOOKS DIFFERENT FOR EACH ZERO

Service Desk	**Zero-Touch Support**	Tier 1 tickets ~75% ↓	Effort per incident 66% ↓	Fully automated services 20%
Tech Operations	**Zero Service Outages**	MTTR 70–90% ↓	Critical outages 58% ↓	Incidents auto-remediated up to 95%
Asset Management	**Zero Asset Issues**	Infrastructure spend 40–50% ↓	Normalisation recognition 98%	Asset audit match 99%
CISO	**Zero Severe Breaches**	Containment time 70–90% ↓	Unaddressed critical vulnerabilities 10% ↓	Security incident close time 50% ↓
Strategy & Planning	**Zero Misaligned Investments**	On-time projects 50% ↑	Demand aligned to strategy 90%	Resource allocation cycle 50% ↓

● ACHIEVED OUTCOME ● KPI TARGET EXAMPLE

ServiceNow business-value estimates and published customer outcomes (sources, page 36). Customer outcomes are not guaranteed; KPI targets require an agreed organisational baseline.

THE CHECKLIST

Five questions. Ten checks.

Autonomous IT is not a technology decision alone. It is a **readiness, control and outcome decision.** Five questions frame this guide. These ten checks answer the last three.

01 · Autonomous IT and the Five Zeros
Understand the ambition · pages 04–07

02 · The AI Readiness Gap
Understand what stands in the way · pages 08–11

03 Are we ready for Autonomous IT?

CLARITY BEFORE COMMITMENT

Check 01
What are we actually prepared to let AI do without a human in the loop?
Define the boundary of autonomous action, what remains human, and where risk is unacceptable.

Check 02
Can our ServiceNow estate give AI context we would trust in production?
AI needs current, connected and reliable data, knowledge and service context to act accurately.

Check 03
If AI makes the wrong decision, can we see why, stop it and recover?
We need explainability, controls, monitoring and a clear rollback path.

Check 04
Where is our weakest readiness foundation today?
Score the four foundations set out on page 14. The lowest one sets the practical ceiling.

04 Which Zero should we pursue first?

FOCUS FOR IMPACT

Check 05
Which Zero solves a problem the business already cares about?
Start where there is real operational pain and a clear, measurable outcome.

Check 06
Which ServiceNow capabilities can our current estate actually support?
Match ambition to what is practical with your platform, integrations, licence tier and data today.

Check 07
Can we prove the outcome in operational data?
If you cannot measure the before, the change and the result, you cannot credibly claim the Zero.

05 How do we get there?

FROM AMBITION TO ACTION

Check 08
What is stopping greater autonomy today?
Is it data quality, fragmented workflows, missing ownership or weak controls?

Check 09
How much autonomy is enough?
The goal is not maximum autonomy. It is the highest level that can be safely operated, evidenced and governed.

Check 10
What can we prove in the next 90 days?
Choose one bounded outcome where greater autonomy can be tested, measured and improved under control.

WHY TAKE THE ROAD TO ZERO WITH CROSSFUZE?

FREE AI READINESS ASSESSMENT

Know where you stand. In 90 minutes.

Walk in already holding the answer. One facilitated session scores your foundations, names your strongest starting Zero and agrees the next 90 days of work.

Book your 90-minute session →

PLUS

Usage estimated upfront.

Know what your Zero will consume before you renew. No surprise bill.

One outcome every 90 days.

Each cycle proves one bounded Zero before the next begins.

Controls you can defend.

Named owners, a kill switch and rollback, mapped to NIST AI RMF and ISO/IEC 42001.

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- SERVICENOW ELITE PARTNER
- 2025 CONSULTING & IMPLEMENTATION PARTNER OF THE YEAR
- AUTHORISED RESELLER

TAKE THE FIRST STEP

Start your Road to Zero today.

Two ways to begin. Both are free, and both give you the readiness baseline every Zero is built on.

OPTION 01 · SELF-SERVE · FREE

Use our calculators.

Get your number in minutes, on your own time. Takes about 10 minutes.

1 **AI Readiness Benchmark**
Are we ready? Scores the foundations and places you on the readiness scale.

2 **Assist Estimator and Tier Map**
What will it consume? A 12-month Now Assist forecast against tier and allocation.

Self-guided
Crossfuze interactive tools

Open the calculators →

crossfuze.com/interactive-tools

OR

OPTION 02 · WITH CROSSFUZE · FREE

RECOMMENDED

Book a 90-min session.

A facilitated AI Readiness Assessment with the Crossfuze AI practice.

- **Validate the limiting foundations**
  What is setting your ceiling, and who owns it.
- **Identify the strongest starting Zero**
  Where autonomy can be earned first.
- **Agree the next 90 days**
  A clear, owned plan of work.



Led by Oliver Nowak
AI Practice Lead, Crossfuze

Book your session →

90 minutes · no cost · no commitment

YOU WALK AWAY WITH

- **A readiness baseline**
- **Your starting Zero**
- **The next 90 days of work**

REFERENCE

Sources & Notes.

Headline outcome estimates PP. 17, 22–26

Source: ServiceNow, “Autonomous IT: Where zeros make heroes,” 2026 (vendor-published). “Numbers listed are estimates based on known customer outcomes and business value assessment projections. Your results may vary.”

(1) **Zero-Touch Support**: ServiceNow estimate, ~75% reduction in Tier 1 tickets. Related: EY reports 75% reduction in overall service ticket volume across 1M+ tickets/year, 30 service desks (customer-reported; measures total volume, not Tier 1 specifically).

(2) **Zero Service Outages**: ServiceNow estimate, 70–90% MTTR reduction. Related: Flight Centre Travel Group reduced MTTR by 80%, incidents by 50% (customer-reported; same metric).

(3) **Zero Asset Issues**: ServiceNow estimate, 40–50% reduction in hardware/software/cloud spend. Related: Community Health Systems (with ServiceNow/KPMG) reports 40% savings in licence true-up costs, 95% of assets auto-tracked (customer-reported; narrower metric: licence true-up, not total spend).

(4) **Zero Severe Breaches**: ServiceNow estimate, 70–90% improvement in time to contain a vulnerability. Related: ServiceNow Now-on-Now reports 85% reduction in security incident close time (vendor’s own result; measures closure, not containment).

(5) **Zero Misaligned Investments**: ServiceNow estimate, ~50% increase in on-time projects. Related: MKS Instruments reports 30% increase in on-time projects: same metric, named customer, lower result. ServiceNow SPM guidance cites 30% as a representative customer KPI.

ServiceNow Enterprise AI Maturity Index 2026 PP. 3, 15

Source: ServiceNow, “Enterprise AI Maturity Index 2026,” Workflow, 9 June 2026. Survey of 4,500 executives across 19 countries and 12 industries. servicenow.com/workflow/ai/enterprise-ai-maturity-index-2026.html. Source for the finding on page 15 that only 20% of enterprises have implemented AI testing, auditing and risk assessment. Also the source for the 59% and 9% figures on page 3. ServiceNow’s maturity guide informs the stage model; Crossfuze’s readiness assessment is a separate framework.

Autonomous IT and the five Zeros P. 4

Sources: ServiceNow Workflow, 1 July 2026 · AI Summit Oslo, 18 June 2026, and Zurich, 2 July 2026 · World Forum New York, 10 September 2026. Insight, Automation and Autonomy are ServiceNow’s Autonomous IT ServiceOps phases, 5 May 2026, published against Zero Touch IT Support and Zero Service Outages; applying them across all five Zeros and across both tracks is Crossfuze’s reading.

Assist consumption PP. 22–26, 31

Source: ServiceNow assist-consumption guidance, 2026. An agentic run using 0–4 tools consumes 25 assists, 5–8 tools 50 assists, and 9–20 tools 150 assists. At equal run volumes, 150 assists per run consumes 6× as many assists as 25 assists per run (150 ÷ 25 = 6). Total consumption also depends on run volume and the mix of actions.

Packages and licensing P. 31

Source: ServiceNow New Commercial Model Overview, April 2026. Process Mining included in Advanced and Prime only.

EVERY STEP TOWARD ZERO

Every step toward zero is capacity returned to the team.

Not people-free. Friction-free.

Autonomous IT is where it starts. **The confidence to keep evolving is what it is for.**

Book your 90-minute session → **Open the calculators →**

Free · 90 minutes · Leave with your readiness baseline, your starting Zero and the next 90 days of work

● CROSSFUZE · SERVICENOW ELITE PARTNER

MORE ON THE FIVE ZEROS **crossfuze.com/campaigns/servicenow-autonomous-it-five-zeros**

Autonomous IT and the Five Zero outcomes are ServiceNow's and are attributed throughout. The Road to Zero is Crossfuze's practical guide to pursuing them. Crossfuze helps you understand where you stand against them, what stands in the way, what the climb will consume, and where to move first.